

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to discuss a strategy!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Why do you think it is important to ask for clarification?
- Do you ask for clarification often? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can deal with a communication breakdown.
- I can interrupt politely and deal with interruptions.





Let's Explore!

What does Polygon have to do? Who is the **client***?

* A "client" can be a person or company that pays another company for a service.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Janet: So, Miranda, how did your meeting with Farmani go?

Miranda: It was good, thanks. I had a chance to get a better insight into their company and what they are they are. The ...

Janet: Sorry for interrupting, but what kind of insight did you get? Could you be more specific?

Miranda: Well, as I was saying, I know they're looking for a PR agency to manage their image, which is not great, and ...

Janet: Excuse me for butting in, but I'm not sure I'm following you. What is wrong with their image? Could you elaborate on that please?

Miranda: Well, there have been numerous recalls on their latest clothing line.

Janet: Do you mean the one for the 35 to 55-year-old women?

Miranda: Yes. ... uh ... Now, what was I saying? Oh yes, they need help with their image and a new clothing line to substitute the last one.

Janet: OK. So what can we do to make things easier for them?

Miranda: We need to formalize an offer with a plan for their image management, media and publicity for their new clothing line.

Janet: I'm not sure I know what you mean. Could you clarify that, please?

Miranda: Well, I'm thinking of creating a Business Link page and pitching it to Farmani.



Let's Practice!

I'm not sure I follow her. What did she say?

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Say the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

I'm not sure I'm following you / Could you be more specific /
I know what you mean / Could you clarify / you mean / elaborate on

1. Sorry for interrupting, but what kind of insight did you get? _____?
2. I'm not sure _____. _____ that, please?
3. Do _____, the one for 35- to 55-year old women?
4. Excuse me for butting in, but _____.
5. What is wrong with their image? Could you _____ that please?



Let's Practice!

Can I just mention something? Can you find what's missing in the sentences?

Instructions: Read the text again. Select the missing phrase that best completes the statements below.

- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>2. _____, what kind of insight did you get?</p> <p>a. Excuse me for butting in, but</p> <p>b. Can I just say something here?</p> <p>c. Sorry for interrupting,</p> | <p>1. _____ I know they're looking for a PR agency to manage their image.</p> <p>a. Well, as I was saying ...</p> <p>b. Where was I?</p> <p>c. Now, what I was saying?</p> |
|---|--|





Extension Activity

Let's ask for clarification!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a dialogue (70-80) words.
- You are talking to a co-worker and there seems to be some confusion.
- You express a lack of understanding and ask for clarification.
- They give you more information.
- You need to ask your co-worker a question. Interrupt them politely.
- They answer your question and get back to the topic of the conversation.
- Underline the different expressions and phrases you used in your dialogue.
- Practice reading your dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I deal with a communication breakdown in the workplace.

☐ ☐

I ask for clarification in a conversation.

☐ ☐

I interrupt a co-worker politely.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- insight** (noun): a clear understanding of something
e.g. I had a chance to get a better insight into their company.
- recall** (noun): when a company asks people to return a product they have bought because there may be something wrong with it
e.g. There have been numerous recalls on their latest clothing line.
- to substitute** (verb): to use one thing instead of another
e.g. They need a new clothing line to substitute their last one.
- page** (noun): all the information that you can see at one time on a website
e.g. I'm going to create a business link page for the company.
- to pitch** (verb): to try to persuade someone to do business with you
e.g. We can create a page and then pitch it to them.
- offer** (noun): a statement saying that you are willing to do something for someone
e.g. We need to formalize an offer with a plan for their image management.





Learning Points

Interrupting Politely and Dealing with Interruptions

In English, sometimes we need to interrupt people. This can be because we need to say something, express our opinion, or make a suggestion.

Interruptions are acceptable in conversations, but too many interruptions can seem rude. Here are some common ways we can interrupt someone:

Interrupting Politely	Getting Back to the Subject
• Sorry for interrupting, but ... • Excuse me for butting in, but ... • Can I stop you there for a second? • Can I just say something here?	• Well/Anyway, as I was saying ... • Going back to what I was saying ... • Where was I? • Now, what was I saying?

Examples:

- **Sorry, for interrupting, but** *what kind of information did you get?*
- **Now, what was I saying?** *Oh right, they need help with their brand.*

Dealing with Communication Breakdowns

Sometimes you don't understand what was said or something was not clear to you. It is, therefore, important to express your lack of understanding and seek clarification from the person you are talking to.

Expressing lack of understanding	Asking for clarification
• Sorry, I am not sure I am following you. • I beg your pardon, but I don't quite understand. • I'm not sure I know what you mean. • I'm not sure I follow you.	• Could you elaborate on that? • Could you be more specific? • Could you repeat that, please? • Could you clarify that, please? • Do you mean ... ?

Examples:

- **Sorry, I am not sure I am following you. Could you be more specific?**
- **I beg your pardon, but I don't quite understand. You mean** *the new fashion line?*

